

MOORE, RUSSELL AND EARLY WITTGENSTEIN

ATTRIBUTION/PERIOD CONTROL → MOORE COMMON SENSE → MOORE ACT/OBJECT → RUSSELL ANALYSIS/FACTS → ACQUAINTANCE/DESCRIPTION → CONSTRUCTIONS → TRACTATUS FACTS/PICTURES → TRUTH-FUNCTIONS → SAY/SHOW/LADDER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

ANALYTIC REVOLT AND THE DISTINCT PROGRAMMES OF THE TRIO

ANALYTIC REVOLT

MOORE: COMMON-SENSE CERTAINTY

RUSSELL: LOGICAL FORM AND CONSTRUCTION

EARLY WITTGENSTEIN: LIMITS OF REPRESENTATION

SHARED METHOD, DISTINCT PROGRAMMES

NOT A SINGLE ATOMISM OR POSITIVISM

THREE QUESTIONS

- MOORE -> what common-sense propositions are more certain than theory?
- RUSSELL -> what logical form lies beneath misleading grammar?
- EARLY WITTGENSTEIN -> what makes representation possible?

THREE METHODS

- MOORE -> certainty comparison and act/object distinctions.
- RUSSELL -> analysis, contextual definition and logical construction.
- EARLY WITTGENSTEIN -> picture theory, truth-functions and say/show.

BOUNDARIES

- UNITY -> analysis replaces speculative system-building.
- DIFFERENCE -> epistemic defence, logical reduction, delimitation of sense.
- CAUTION -> verificationism is later; the trio do not share one atomism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Speculative whole -> Moore tests it against what is better known -> Russell rewrites misleading grammar -> Wittgenstein asks what any proposition must share with a possible fact.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Moore defends ordinary commitments, Russell contextually analyses grammar, and early Wittgenstein delimits factual representation; their programmes are distinct.

01

STAGE 01

MOORE'S COMMON-SENSE PROPOSITIONS AND EXTERNAL-WORLD PROOF

1925: QUALIFIED COMMON-SENSE TRUISMS

KNOWING P != COMPLETE ANALYSIS OF P

1939: HERE IS ONE HAND; HERE IS ANOTHER

PREMISES KNOWN AND DISTINCT

VALID PROOF != NEUTRAL SCEPTICAL CRITERION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- 1925 DEFENCE → qualified truisms about body, earth, other persons and temporal life.
- KNOWING P != possessing a complete philosophical ANALYSIS of P.
- ANALYTICAL DIFFICULTY about body/material object does not cancel ordinary knowledge.
- 1939 PROOF → here is one hand + here is another → external objects exist.

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- PROOF TEST 1 → premises differ from conclusion; TEST 2 → premises are known.
- PROOF TEST 3 → conclusion follows: hands are things met with in space.
- SCEPTIC → you assume precisely what dream or deception scenarios place in doubt.
- MOORE → hand-premises are more certain than any premise used to deny them.

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- LIMIT → formally valid proof does not provide a neutral criterion of knowledge.
- RESULT → external-world proof shifts the burden; it is not total scepticism's end.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Known hand-premises + premises distinct from conclusion + valid entailment -> at least two external objects -> an external world exists.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Moore's common sense is comparative certainty rather than popular opinion, and the hands proof shifts rather than neutralises the sceptical burden.

02

STAGE 02

MOORE'S AWARENESS-OBJECT DISTINCTION AND TRANSPARENCY

ESSE EST PERCIPI TARGETED

AWARENESS != PRESENTED OBJECT

BLUE AND GREEN: OBJECTS DIFFER

CONSCIOUSNESS: COMMON RELATION

TRANSPARENCY EXPLAINS THE CONFLATION

TARGET → esse est percipi: the object's being is identified with being perceived.

BLUE EXPERIENCE → AWARENESS directed toward BLUE; green has the same relation.

COMMON ELEMENT → awareness/consciousness; VARIABLE ELEMENT → presented object.

THEREFORE → awareness != blue and awareness != green.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- TARGET → esse est percipi: the object's being is identified with being perceived.
- BLUE EXPERIENCE → AWARENESS directed toward BLUE; green has the same relation.
- COMMON ELEMENT → awareness/consciousness; VARIABLE ELEMENT → presented object.
- THEREFORE → awareness != blue and awareness != green.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- TRANSPARENCY / DIAPHANOUSNESS → attention passes through awareness to its object.
- IDEALIST TEMPTATION → because the act is elusive, identify sensation with its object.
- MOOREAN REPLY → being overlooked does not make awareness identical with the object.
- NARROW RESULT → the identity route from object to awareness is blocked.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LIMIT → distinguishability does not prove every object exists unperceived.
- BERKELEY CAUTION → Moore does not refute Berkeley's entire philosophy in one stroke.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Awareness differs from its object, blocking esse=percipi; unperceived mind-independent existence still requires further argument.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Moore's decisive point is not that every idealism has been disproved, but that the object of awareness cannot simply be identified with awareness merely because consciousness is transparent to introspection.

03

STAGE 03

RUSSELL'S LOGICAL ANALYSIS, FACTS AND ATOMIC PROPOSITIONS

GRAMMATICAL FORM != LOGICAL FORM

WORLD AS OBTAINING FACTS

PARTICULARS + UNIVERSALS/RELATIONS

ATOMIC FACT <=> ATOMIC PROPOSITION

LOGICAL, NOT PHYSICAL, ATOMS

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05

STAGE 05

LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS, INFERRED ENTITIES AND LOGICAL FICTIONS

CONSTRUCTION REPLACES INFERRED ENTITY

DERIVED STRUCTURE, NOT BASIC ATOM

LOGICAL FICTION: CONTEXTUAL SHORTHAND

WHEREVER POSSIBLE: QUALIFIED MAXIM

ONTOLOGICAL ECONOMY, NOT IMAGINARY OBJECTS

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
MAXIM → wherever possible, substitute logical constructions for inferred entities.	INFERRED ENTITY → primitive posit avoided when a construction succeeds.	OBJECTION → private or possible sense-data may not reconstruct public endurance.
OLD ROUTE → data/appearances → infer an additional unknown entity X.	LOGICAL FICTION → useful contextual shorthand, not an additional denoted object.	LIMITED REPLY → the wherever-possible maxim survives better than total reduction.
NEW ROUTE → define X-talk as a structure of relations among safer entities.	EXAMPLES → physical objects/sense-data; numbers/classes; points/volumes, with caution.	
CONSTRUCTION → derived structure preserving explanatory work.	ATOM != CONSTRUCTION → basic residue versus derived structure.	

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EVALUATION / TRAP

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- LIMITED REPLY → the wherever-possible maxim survives better than total reduction.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Descriptions and constructions eliminate pseudo-constituents and support atomist analysis without proving termination or one final ontology.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Russell's maxim is best read as disciplined ontological economy: construction replaces commitment to an inferred entity without making ordinary object-talk simply false or imaginary.

06

STAGE 06

INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND DEFINITE-DESCRIPTION ANALYSIS

INCOMPLETE SYMBOL: NO STANDALONE DENOTATION

CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION OF THE WHOLE SENTENCE

EXISTENCE + UNIQUENESS + PREDICATION

KING OF FRANCE: CONJUNCTION FALSE

SCOPE CHANGES NEGATION

DESCRIPTION → 'the F' appears to name but disappears on logical analysis.

→

STAGE 1 EXISTENCE → at least one x is F.

→

STAGE 2 UNIQUENESS → every y that is F is identical with x.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- INCOMPLETE SYMBOL → no standalone denotation; defined only in proposition-context.
- DESCRIPTION → 'the F' appears to name but disappears on logical analysis.
- STAGE 1 EXISTENCE → at least one x is F.
- STAGE 2 UNIQUENESS → every y that is F is identical with x.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- STAGE 3 PREDICATION → that x is G.
- KING OF FRANCE → existence fails, so the standard conjunction is false.
- GOLDEN MOUNTAIN → no ghostly object; apparent subject is eliminated.
- SCOPE → negation outside the whole claim differs from negating the predicate.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- STRAWSON → ordinary use presupposes existence; Russell stresses truth conditions.
- RESULT → grammatical completeness can conceal logical incompleteness.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Surface 'the F is G' -> assert at least one F -> assert at most one F -> predicate G of that F -> evaluate the conjunction and its scope.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The theory of descriptions shows that a grammatically complete subject can be logically incomplete, because its contribution is exhausted by a contextual definition of the proposition in which it occurs.

07

STAGE 07

TRACTARIAN OBJECTS, STATES OF AFFAIRS, FACTS AND PICTURES

EARLY WITTGENSTEIN ONLY

OBJECT -> STATE OF AFFAIRS -> FACT

NAME -> ELEMENTARY PROPOSITION

SHARED LOGICAL FORM

PICTURE != VISUAL RESEMBLANCE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- EARLY ONLY → do not import later meaning-as-use, forms of life or language-games.
- WORLD → totality of FACTS, not a mere list of things.
- OBJECTS → simple combinatorial possibilities; their nature is not concretely specified.
- STATE OF AFFAIRS → possible combination of objects; obtaining state → FACT.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NAME → corresponds to object; names combine in an ELEMENTARY PROPOSITION.
- PROPOSITION → pictures a possible state of affairs through shared LOGICAL FORM.
- PICTURE != VISUAL RESEMBLANCE → medium may differ while possibility matches.
- TRUE → pictured arrangement obtains; FALSE → it does not, yet proposition has sense.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SENSE → possession of truth-conditions or a possible situation in logical space.
- LIMIT → no uncontested examples of fully analysed elementary propositions are given.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Objects combine possibly -> state of affairs; if it obtains -> fact. Names combine -> elementary proposition; shared logical form makes it a picture whose truth depends on reality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Tractarian states of affairs and objects are logical/combinatorial, not Russellian sense-data; translation of Sachverhalt must be controlled.

08

STAGE 08

TRUTH-FUNCTIONS, LOGICAL SCAFFOLDING AND LIMITING CASES

SENSE AS TRUTH-CONDITIONS

COMPLEX PROPOSITIONS AS TRUTH-FUNCTIONS

LOGICAL CONSTANTS ARE NOT OBJECTS

TAUTOLOGY / CONTRADICTION: LIMITING CASES

NONSENSE != TAUTOLOGY

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SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ELEMENTARY BASE → propositions representing possible independent states of affairs.
- TRUTH-OPERATION → builds complex propositions from truth-values of the base.
- MOLECULAR p AND q / p OR q / NOT p → no extra logical object is represented.
- LOGICAL CONSTANTS → operations, not names standing for entities.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LOGIC → shows the formal scaffolding of world and language; it states no facts.
- TAUTOLOGY → always true, well formed, but says nothing contingent.
- CONTRADICTION → always false, well formed, but says nothing contingent.
- NONSENSE → fails to picture any possible fact; not identical with tautology.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CRITICISM → colour exclusion and belief contexts pressure independence/functionality.
- VERDICT → architecture is powerful but its elementary base remains underspecified.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Elementary independence and truth-functionality are programme commitments pressured by colour exclusion and non-extensional contexts, not verificationism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Tractarian economy makes logical form the scaffolding of representation: truth-functions combine possible pictures without adding logical objects to the world.

09

STAGE 09

SAYING-SHOWING, COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER SPINE

FACTUAL PROPOSITIONS SAY

LOGICAL FORM AND NECESSITY SHOW

ETHICS AND THE MYSTICAL ARE NOT ORDINARY FACTS

6.54: USE AND DISCARD THE LADDER

SELF-REFERENCE REMAINS A REAL TENSION

SAYING → factual propositions state how things contingently stand.

SHOWING → logical form, necessity and limits manifest in meaningful symbolism.

ETHICS/AESTHETICS/MYSTICAL → not ordinary facts and not simply dismissed as false.

LADDER 6.54 → use elucidatory remarks, see the boundary, then discard the rungs.

SELF-REFERENCE → the Tractatus's own remarks appear nonsensical by its criterion.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SAYING → factual propositions state how things contingently stand.
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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SELF-REFERENCE → the Tractatus's own remarks appear nonsensical by its criterion.
- REPLY → self-consuming elucidation is deliberate; RESIDUAL → communication remains hard.
- MOORE → protect common-sense knowledge through analysis and certainty comparison.
- RUSSELL → reveal logical form and construct/reduce problematic entities.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- EARLY WITTGENSTEIN → delimit meaningful representation through say/show.
- POSITIVISM BOUND → later verificationism must not be imported into the Tractatus.
- ANSWER SPINE → thesis → definitions → argument → example → objection/reply → verdict.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Proposition pictures a fact -> picturing presupposes logical form -> another proposition cannot picture that presupposition as a fact -> form is shown, not said -> elucidatory ladder is discarded.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Saying/showing culminates in the deliberate ladder problem; standard ineffability and resolute readings differ, while later doctrine stays locked.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED SESSION 1 — THE ANALYTIC REVOLT AND THE

ADVANCED SESSION 2 — MOORE - DEFENCE OF COMMON

ADVANCED SESSION 3 — MOORE - THE REFUTATION OF

ADVANCED SESSION 4 — RUSSELL - LOGICAL ATOMISM (ATOMIC

ADVANCED SESSION 5 — RUSSELL - INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND

ADVANCED SESSION 6 — RUSSELL - KNOWLEDGE BY ACQUAINTANCE

ADVANCED SESSION 7 — RUSSELL - LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS (SENSE-DATA

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — The Analytic Revolt and the Attribution Map - Who Owns What
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Moore - Defence of Common Sense, Truisms, Knowing vs Analysing, the Proof of an External World
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Moore - The Refutation of Idealism (Act/Object Distinction and the Diaphanous Thesis)
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Russell - Logical Atomism (Atomic Facts, Truth-Functions, Isomorphism; Logical not Physical Atoms)

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Russell - Incomplete Symbols and the Theory of Descriptions
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Russell - Knowledge by Acquaintance vs Knowledge by Description (Bismarck; Logically Proper Names)
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Russell - Logical Constructions (Sense-Data, Inferred Entities; Substitute Constructions for Inferences)
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Early Wittgenstein - The Tractatus World of Facts and the Picture Theory of Meaning

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Early Wittgenstein - Bipolarity, Logical Space, the General Form of the Proposition, and Tautology/Contradiction
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Early Wittgenstein - Saying vs Showing, the Mystical, the Ladder Metaphor and Proposition 7
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- Moore's commonsense realism is not Russell's logical analysis: Moore defends ordinary knowledge and refuses to let analysis override it

OPTIONAL STATUS

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.